SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #25 · MEDIA AND SOCIAL MEDIA

“If it feels good, it must be okay.”

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Where it often comes from

Culture often says, “Follow your heart,” and “If it feels right, do it.” Feelings are real and important, but they are not reliable moral guides, especially when tired, hurt, tempted, or in a rush. This belief can lead to choices we later regret.

What Scripture teaches

Proverbs says, “There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death.” “Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding.” “Be not wise in your own eyes; fear the LORD and turn away from evil.” Paul says, “Pay careful attention, then, to how you walk, not as unwise but as wise.” Feelings are information. They tell us what we want or fear, but they are not the final word. Wisdom weighs feelings against God’s word and the long-term consequences.

> *“There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death”* (Proverbs 14:12).

Also see

> “Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight” (Proverbs 3:5–6).

> “Be not wise in your own eyes; fear the LORD and turn away from evil” (Proverbs 3:7).

> “Pay careful attention, then, to how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil” (Ephesians 5:15–16).

> “Finally, brothers, whatever is true, whatever is honorable, whatever is right, whatever is pure, whatever is lovely, whatever is admirable—if anything is excellent or praiseworthy—think on these things” (Philippians 4:8).

Common self-statements

- If it feels right, it is right.
- My feelings tell me what is true.
- I deserve to feel good.
- If no one is hurt, it is fine.
- I will not know until I try it.
- My heart cannot lead me wrong.

Common logical errors

- Emotional reasoning: Treating feelings as facts or moral guides.
- Short-term thinking: Ignoring consequences.
- Rationalization: Finding reasons to justify what I want.
- Minimizing: Assuming no one is hurt.

Challenging questions

- What is my feeling telling me, and what does it want?
- What are the likely consequences a month or a year from now?

- What does Scripture say about this choice?
- Who might be affected that I have not thought of?
- Whom could I ask for wise counsel?
- Have my feelings misled me before?

Truth summary

> Feelings are important signals but not the final guide. I can listen to them, then weigh them against God's word, wise counsel, and consequences. Wisdom often means choosing what is right when it does not feel best.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Wisdom
- Temptation
- Thinking, Unhealthy
- Guidance
- Will of God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Anxiety/Worry/Fear

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Truth Be Told — Matthew West featuring Carly Pearce
Honesty about struggles makes room for grace and support instead of pretending to be fine.

Voice of Truth — Casting Crowns
Test accusing or frightening messages against God's truth.

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If it feels good, it must be okay"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If it feels good, it must be okay." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What am I feeling?
- ☐ What are the consequences?
- ☐ What does Scripture say?
- ☐ Who is affected?
- ☐ Whom can I ask?
- ☐ Have feelings misled me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Feelings are information, not authority.
- ☐ A way that seems right can lead astray.
- ☐ I can trust the Lord over my own understanding.
- ☐ Wisdom weighs consequences.
- ☐ Wise counsel protects me.
- ☐ I can choose what is right.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 14:12**
  "There is a way that seems right to a man, but its end is the way of death."
- ☐ **Proverbs 3:5–6**
  "Trust in the LORD with all your heart, and lean not on your own understanding; in all your ways acknowledge Him, and He will make your paths straight."
- ☐ **Ephesians 5:15–16**
  "Pay careful attention, then, to how you walk, not as unwise but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Feeling and wisdom: Each week, note one decision where you weighed feelings against wisdom.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Proverbs 14:12 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will trust the Lord over my own feelings and understanding.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Wisdom" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Name the feeling. Write what you feel and what it wants.
- ☐ Think ahead. Write likely outcomes in a week, month, and year.
- ☐ Check with Scripture. Look up relevant passages.
- ☐ Ask a wise friend. Get counsel before deciding.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If it feels good, it must be okay": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Feeling and wisdom
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If it feels good, it must be okay.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, my feelings are strong. Teach me to listen to them, but to trust You above them. Give me wisdom, wise counselors, and courage to choose what is right. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.